

BATSFORD CHESS

LOGICAL CHESS

MOVE BY MOVE

EVERY MOVE EXPLAINED

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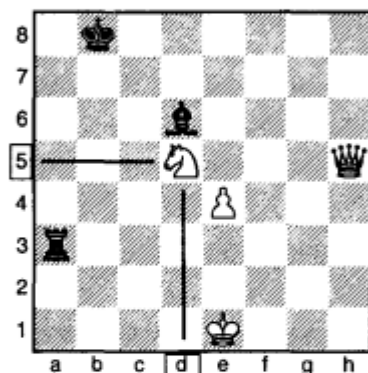
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Chess Notation and Symbols

This book uses the universally accepted *algebraic notation*, in which each chess move is written using a simple system of coordinates similar to map references.

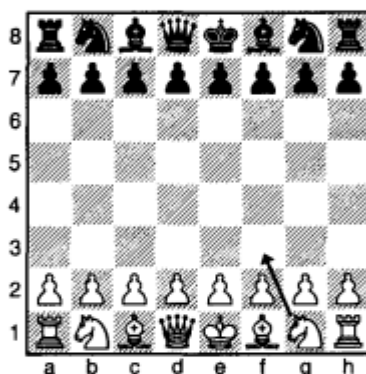


By a generally accepted convention, chess diagrams such as the above are always presented from White's point of view; i.e. White started the game at the bottom of the board. Indeed, his king stands on its original square.

The vertical rows of squares, called *files*, are lettered a to h from left to right. The horizontal rows, called *ranks*, are numbered from 1 to 8, beginning at the bottom of the diagram, i.e. from White's side. Each square lies on the intersection of a file and a rank, for example the lines in the above diagram show that the white knight stands on the intersection of the d-file and the fifth rank.

Thus the square on which the knight stands is referred to as *d5*.

In a similar way, the rook stands on *a3*, the bishop on *d6*, the pawn on *e4*, the queen on *h5*, the white king on *e1* and the black king on *b8*.



The above diagram shows how the men are set up at the start of the game, with a player's eight pieces placed on the row nearest him and the eight pawns directly in front of the pieces.

When recording the moves of a game, first the piece is given and then the square to which the piece moves. For example, if White plays the move indicated by the arrow, moving his knight from g1 to f3, then we write the move ♞f3. As is usual in books, we use figurines to denote the piece in chess notation: ♔ for king, ♑ for queen, ♖ for rook, ♗ for bishop and ♘ for knight. No figurine

8 Chess Notation and Symbols

is used in the case of a pawn move. When writing moves down by hand (for example when keeping the record of a game played in a tournament), it is usual to use the first letter of its name instead of a figurine – K for king, Q for queen, R for rook, and B for bishop. As the letter K has already been used for the king, the knight is normally denoted by N.

There are a few other symbols that are important in chess notation:

- x captures
- O-O castles on the kingside
- O-O-O castles on the queenside
- + check
- ++ double check
- # checkmate
- ! a good move
- !! an excellent or brilliant move
- ? a mistake
- ?? a serious mistake or blunder

Finally, in this book the symbol (D) indicates a point in the game at which a chess diagram appears.

As practice in the use of chess notation, try playing over the moves of the following game, starting from the initial position:

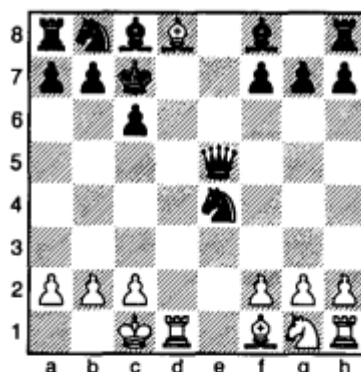
Réti – Tartakower

Offhand game, Vienna 1910

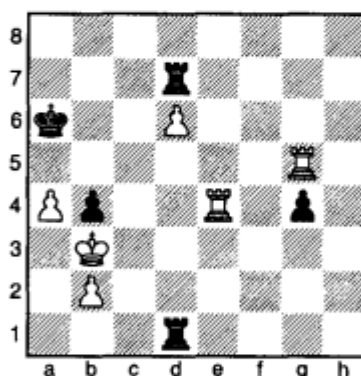
Caro-Kann Defence

1 e4 c6 2 d4 d5 3 Nc3 dx e4 4 Nxe4
 Nf6 5 Wd3 e5 6 dx e5 Wa5+ 7 Ad2
 Wxe5 8 O-O-O Nxe4 9 Wd8+!! exd8
 10 Ag5++ exc7 11 $\text{Ad8\#}$ (1-0)

You should have the following final position set up on your board:



If two pieces of the same type can move to the same square, then the possible ambiguity in the notation requires extra information.



If it is White to play here then either rook can take the pawn on g4. In order to distinguish between the two captures we write Rexg4 or Rgxc4 according to whether it is the e4-rook or the g5-rook that takes the pawn. If Black is to play, we distinguish between the two captures on d6 by adding the rank of the capturing rook i.e., either ...R7xd6 or ...R1xd6 . Here we cannot use the file as both rooks stand on the d-file.

pawn formation makes things easy for Tarrasch, who caps the victory with a quiet little pawn move.

The next two games do not belong, strictly speaking, in the category of kingside attacks. I include them to show the consequences of failure to provide for the safety of the king.

Alekhine-Poindle (No. 15) has some delightfully unconventional moves by Alekhine to punish time-wasting play. Black is hindered from

castling, and his king kept in the centre, where it is exposed to a fatal attack.

Tarrasch-Kurschner (No. 16) is a short story depicting harsh treatment of plausible but perfunctory chess. Tarrasch punishes his opponent's infractions of principle by driving his pieces back where they interfere with each other, prevents Black's king from castling and then assails him with every piece available.

Game 1
von Scheve – Teichmann
Berlin 1907
Giuoco Piano

The chief object of all opening strategy is to get the pieces out quickly – off the back rank and into active play.

You cannot attack (let alone try to checkmate) with one or two pieces.

You must develop all of them, as each one has a job to do.

A good way to begin is to release two pieces at one stroke, and this can be done by advancing one of the centre pawns.

1 e4

This is an excellent opening move. White anchors a pawn in the centre of the board and opens lines for his queen and a bishop. His next move, if he is allowed, will be 2 d4. The two pawns will then control four squares on the fifth rank, c5, d5, e5 and f5, and prevent Black from placing any of his pieces on those important squares.

How shall Black reply to White's first move? He must not waste time

considering meaningless moves, such as 1...h6 or 1...a6. These and other aimless moves do nothing toward developing the pieces, nor do they interfere with White's threat to monopolize the centre.

Black must fight for an equal share of the good squares. Black must dispute possession of the centre.

Why all this stress on the centre? Why is it so important?

Pieces placed in the centre enjoy the greatest freedom of action and have the widest scope for their attacking powers. A knight, for example, posted in the centre, reaches out in eight directions and attacks eight squares. Standing at the side of the board, its range of attack is limited to four squares. It is only half a knight!

Occupation of the centre means control of the most valuable territory. It leaves less room for the enemy's